

Cascade RV Solar Solutions — AI Phone Receptionist

Complete Setup & Deployment Guide

Overview

This AI phone receptionist answers calls on behalf of Cascade RV Solar Solutions using your existing phone number via **Conditional Call Forwarding**.

When your phone is on **Do Not Disturb**, busy, or unanswered, calls will automatically forward to the AI Receptionist instead of your standard voicemail.

Component	Service	Purpose
Phone Number	Twilio	Receives forwarded calls from your personal phone
AI Brain	OpenAI GPT-4o	Understands and responds to callers
Voice	Amazon Polly (via Twilio)	Professional neutral American male voice
Backend	Python + FastAPI	Runs the receptionist logic
Dashboard	Web Interface	Allows you to toggle the AI ON/OFF

What the receptionist does:

- Greets callers professionally as “Alex” from Cascade RV Solar Solutions
- Answers FAQs about services, pricing, timeline, warranty, and service area
- Captures caller name, phone number, email, and inquiry details
- Takes messages for Jason
- Routes urgent calls by noting them for priority callback
- Saves all leads to a file for manual CRM entry

Step 1 — Prerequisites

You will need accounts with the following services:

1a. OpenAI Account

1. Go to platform.openai.com
2. Sign up or log in
3. Navigate to **API Keys** → **Create new secret key**
4. Copy the key — you will need it in Step 3

Estimated cost: GPT-4o costs approximately 0.005 *per minute of conversation*. A typical 3 – minute call costs about 0.015.

1b. Twilio Account

1. Go to twilio.com and sign up for a free account
 2. Verify your phone number
 3. From the Twilio Console, note your:
 - **Account SID** (starts with `AC`)
 - **Auth Token**
 4. Purchase a phone number (this is the number your personal phone will forward to):
 - Go to **Phone Numbers** → **Manage** → **Buy a Number**
 - Choose an Oregon area code (503 or 541) if desired
 - Enable **Voice** capability
 - Cost: approximately \$1.15/month per number
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Step 2 — Install the Receptionist

Option A — Run on Your Own Computer or Server

Requirements: Python 3.10 or higher

```
# 1. Download the receptionist files to a folder
cd cascade_receptionist

# 2. Install dependencies
pip install -r requirements.txt

# 3. Copy and fill in your configuration
cp .env.example .env
# Edit .env with your actual API keys (see Step 3)

# 4. Start the server
./start.sh
```

The server will start on `http://localhost:8000`

Option B — Deploy to a Cloud Server (Recommended for ²⁴/₇ operation)

For always-on operation, deploy to a cloud provider:

Recommended options (free or low cost):

- [Railway.app](#) — Free tier available, easy deployment
- [Render.com](#) — Free tier available
- [DigitalOcean](#) — \$6/month droplet

Railway deployment (easiest):

```
# Install Railway CLI
npm install -g @railway/cli

# Login and deploy
railway login
railway init
railway up
```

Step 3 — Configure Your .env File

Edit the `.env` file with your actual credentials:

```
OPENAI_API_KEY=sk- ... your-actual-openai-key ...
TWILIO_ACCOUNT_SID=ACxxxxxxxxxxxxxxxxxxxxxxxxxxxxxxxx
TWILIO_AUTH_TOKEN=your-actual-twilio-auth-token
TWILIO_PHONE_NUMBER=+15031234567
OWNER_PHONE=+15039190521
OWNER_EMAIL=jhefley@cascadesolarrvsolutions.com
```

Step 4 — Connect Twilio to Your Receptionist

1. Log in to [Twilio Console](#)
2. Go to **Phone Numbers** → **Manage** → **Active Numbers**
3. Click on your purchased Twilio phone number
4. Under **Voice & Fax** → **A Call Comes In**:
 - Set to **Webhook**
 - Enter your server URL: `https://YOUR-SERVER-URL/incoming-call`
 - Method: **HTTP POST**
5. Under **Call Status Changes**:
 - Enter: `https://YOUR-SERVER-URL/call-status`
 - Method: **HTTP POST**
6. Click **Save**

Step 5 — Set Up Conditional Call Forwarding

To make your personal phone forward to the AI Receptionist when you are busy or on Do Not Disturb, you need to set up **Conditional Call Forwarding** with your carrier.

Note: Replace `[TWILIO_NUMBER]` with the 10-digit Twilio phone number you purchased in Step 1 (e.g., `5031234567`).

For Verizon

- **To Activate:** Dial *71 followed by your [TWILIO_NUMBER] , then press Call. Listen for a series of beeps, then hang up.
- **To Deactivate:** Dial *73 and press Call.

For AT&T

- **To Activate:** Dial *92 followed by your [TWILIO_NUMBER] , then press # and Call.
- **To Deactivate:** Dial *93# and press Call.

For T-Mobile

- **To Activate (No Answer):** Dial **61*1 followed by your [TWILIO_NUMBER] , then press # and Call.
- **To Activate (Busy/DND):** Dial **67*1 followed by your [TWILIO_NUMBER] , then press # and Call.
- **To Deactivate:** Dial ##004# and press Call.

For iPhone Users (Alternative Method)

If the carrier codes do not work, you can set up standard forwarding:

1. Go to **Settings > Phone > Call Forwarding**
2. Toggle it ON and enter your Twilio number. *(Note: This forwards ALL calls immediately, rather than just unanswered ones).*

For Android Users (Alternative Method)

1. Open the **Phone** app.
2. Tap the three dots (Menu) > **Settings > Call Forwarding** (or Supplementary Services).
3. Select **Forward when busy** and **Forward when unanswered**.
4. Enter your Twilio number for both.

Step 6 — How to Use the Dashboard

Your receptionist comes with a web dashboard accessible at your server URL (e.g., <https://YOUR-SERVER-URL/>).

From the dashboard, you can:

1. Toggle the Receptionist ON/OFF:

- When **ACTIVE**, the AI will answer forwarded calls and converse with the customer.
- When **INACTIVE**, the system will simply play a standard voicemail greeting (“We are unable to take your call...”) and record a message, bypassing the AI.

2. View Leads: Click “View Captured Leads” to see a list of all callers who provided their information or left a voicemail.

The Workflow

1. Keep the AI Receptionist toggled **ON** in the dashboard.
 2. When you are working on a project, put your personal phone in **Do Not Disturb (DND)**.
 3. Incoming calls to your personal phone will automatically forward to the Twilio number.
 4. The AI Receptionist will answer, assist the customer, and take a message/lead.
 5. When you are done, turn off DND on your phone to resume taking calls normally.
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Support

For questions about this AI receptionist setup, refer to:

- [Twilio Documentation](#)
 - [OpenAI API Documentation](#)
 - [FastAPI Documentation](#)
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Built for Cascade RV Solar Solutions | Prineville, Oregon | (503) 919-0521